

6.2 Other Options

6.2.1 Using Gmail

If you prefer to have direct online access, rather than install and configure software, Gmail can be a good central repository for all your e-mail IDs. If the e-mail provider supports mail forwarding or POP access, you can configure your mail accounts to be used directly from within Gmail without the recipients being any the wiser about the origins of the mail message. You can set up Gmail such that even your outgoing mail will carry your official ID.

To set up Gmail for all your IDs, log in to your Gmail account, click **Settings**, and select **Accounts**. The first option **Send E-mail AS** allows you to send e-mail from your Gmail account using any of your other IDs. To enable this, click **Add another e-mail address**, and in the pop-up window, enter your display name and the e-mail address you want to use. Google will send a verification message to that e-mail ID. Log in to there and click on the verification link. Once verified, you can use that mail ID as the sender ID from your Gmail account. By setting a different reply-to address, you can have the replies come back directly to your Gmail account rather than go back to the sending mail ID.

If you do not want to expose your personal IDs or Gmail IDs, and you have POP access to your mail account, you can use the **Get mail from other accounts:** option to configure POP access to your mailboxes. The steps are fairly straightforward, and are similar to what you would do with a Desktop client like Thunderbird. Gmail will helpfully suggest that you create a label with the configured e-mail ID so that you can easily identify the mailbox.

If POP access is not supported and your e-mail provider supports e-mail forwarding, log in to that e-mail account and set it to forward all your messages to your Gmail account. Log in to Gmail create a filter based on the e-mail ID so that you can easily identify the forwarded mail.